pret. sing. already in prim. Germanic, cp. Goth. **ēt**, O.Icel. OS. **āt**, OHG. **āz** (§ 119). **cweþan**, *to say*, **cwæþ**, **cwǣdon**, **cweden**; **wesan**, *to be*, pret. pl. **wǣron** (§ 239). **genesan**, *to be saved*, and **lesan**, *to collect, gather*, have extended the **s** of the present and pret. sing. to all forms of the verb.

§ **506.** **sēon** (Goth. **saíhvan**) from ***seohan** (§ 87), *to see*, **seah** (§ 68), **sāwon** beside **sǣgon** (§ 241), **sewen** (§ 241) beside **sawen** with **a** difficult to account for, and Anglian **gesegen** with **g** from the pret. plural; and similarly **gefēon**, *to rejoice*, **gefeah**, pret. pl. **gefǣgon**; **plēon**, *to risk*, pret. sing. **pleah**.

§ **507.** To this class also belong **biddan**, *to pray*; **licgan**, *to lie down*; **sittan**, *to sit*, which originally had **j** in the present (§ 254): **biddan** (Goth. **bidjan**), **bæd** (Goth. **baþ**), **bǣdon** (Goth. **bēdun**), **beden** (Goth. **bidans**). The pret. pl. of **licgan** is **lāgon** beside **lǣgon** (§ 120). **þicgan**, *to receive*, is a weak verb in WS.; in poetry it has the strong forms **þeah** (**þāh**), **þǣgon**, **þegen**. **fricgan**, *to ask, inquire*, with strong pp. **gefrigen**, **gefrugen** (cp. § 502).

## Class VI.

§ **508.** The verbs of this class belong to the sixth ablaut-series (§ 226), and have **a** in the present, **ō** in the pret. sing. and plural, and **æ** beside **a** in the past participle. There is a good deal of fluctuation between **æ** and **a** in the past participle, as **færen**, **græfen**, **sæcen**, **slægen** beside **faren**, **grafen**, **sacen**, **slagen**. The regular development of Germanic **a** when followed by a palatal vowel in the next syllable is **æ** (§ 54), so that forms with **a** like **faren**, &c., are new formations with **a** from the present, see § 54, Note 3.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **faran**, *to go* | **fōr** | **fōron** | **færen**, **faren** |
| Goth. | **faran** | **fōr** | **fōrun** | **farans** |

And similarly **alan**, *to grow*; **bacan**, *to bake*; **calan**, *to be cold*; **galan**, *to sing*; **grafan**, *to dig*; **hladan**, *to lade*,

*load*; **sacan**, *to strive, quarrel*; **wacan**, *to awake, be born*; **wadan**, *to go*; **wascan**, *to wash*. **gnagan** (pret. sing. **gnōg** beside **gnōh**, § **323**), *to gnaw*; and similarly **dragan**, *to draw*. **scacan**, **sceacan** (§ **57**, Note), *to shake*, **scōc**, **sceōc** (§ **128**, Note), **scacen**, **sceacen**; and similarly **scafan**, **sceafan**, *to shave, scrape*. **standan** (Goth. **standan**), *to stand*, **stōd**, **stōdon**, **standen**, with **n** from the present. **spanan**, *to allure*, pret. **spōn** beside **spēon** which was formed after the analogy of verbs of class VII.

§ **509**.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **slēan**, *to strike* | **slōg, slōh** | **slōgon** | **slægen, slagen** |

**slēan** (Goth. **slahan**) from ***sleahan** (§ **70**); **slōg** with **g** from the plural, beside **slōh** (§ **323**), **slōgon** (§ **239**); beside **slægen**, **slagen** there also occurs **slegen** with **i**-umlaut (§ **442**); and similarly **flēan**, *to flay*; **lēan**, *to blame*; **þwēan**, *to wash*.

§ **510**. To this class also belong **hebban** (Goth. **hafjan**), *to raise*; **hliehhan** (Goth. **hlahjan**), *to laugh*; **sceþþan** (Goth. **skaþjan**), *to injure*, cp. § **526**; **scieppan** (Goth. **ga-skapjan**), *to create*; **stæppan** beside **steppan** (§ **55**, Note 3), *to step, go*; **swerian**, *to swear*, which originally had **j** in the present (§ **271**).

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **hebban** | **hōf** | **hōfon** | **hæfen, hafen** |
| **hliehhan** | **hlōg, hlōh** | **hlōgon** | |
| **sceþþan** | **scōd** | **scōdon** | |
| **scieppan** | **scōp** | **scōpon** | **sceapen** |
| **stæppan** | **stōp** | **stōpon** | **stæpen, stapen** |
| **swerian** | **swōr** | **swōron** | **sworen** |

**hebban** has also weak pret. and pp. in late WS. (**hefde, hefod**); beside **hæfen** there also occurs **hefen** (§ **442**). **hlōg** with **g** from the plural beside **hlōh** (§ **323**). The regular WS. form of **sceþþan** would be **scieþþan** (§ **51**). On **sceō-** beside **scō-**, see § **128**, Note. On **sceapen**, see

§ **57**, Note. **sworen** with **o** from analogy of verbs of class IV as in OHG. **gisworan**.

### Class VII.

§ **511.** To this class belong those verbs which originally had reduplicated preterites like Goth. **haíhald, laílōt, faíflōk, haíháit, raírōþ, laíláik,** inf. **haldan,** *to hold,* **lētan,** *to let,* **flōkan,** *to complain,* **háitan,** *to call,* **rēdan,** *to advise,* **láikan,** *to leap.* Traces of the old reduplicated preterites have been preserved in Anglian and in poetry, viz. **hēht** (also WS.), **leolc, leort, ondreord, reɔrd,** beside inf. **hātan, lācan, lǣtan, ondrǣdan, rǣdan,** see below. This class of verbs is divided into two sub-divisions according as the preterite had **ē** or **ēo.** Much has been written about the stem-vowel in the preterite of these verbs, but little or nothing is really known of how it came about. It is usually assumed to be due to the old reduplicated syllable having undergone contraction with the stem-syllable, but this assumption leaves many phonological difficulties unexplained. The preterite sing. and pl. have the same stem-vowel.

#### Sub-division I.

§ **512.** **hātan,** *to call* **hēt** **hāten**

And similarly **lācan,** *to play;* **scādan, sceādan** (§ **133,** Note **2**), *to separate,* pret. **scēd** beside **scēad.**

§ **513.** **lǣtan,** *to let, allow* **lēt** **lǣten**

And similarly **ondrǣdan** (WS. also weak pret. **ondrǣdde**), *to dread, fear;* **rǣdan** (pret. and pp. mostly weak in WS.: **rǣdde, gerǣdd**), *to advise;* **slǣpan** (WS. also weak pret. **slǣpte**). **blandan,** *to mix,* pret. **blēnd,** pp. **blanden.**

§ **514.** **fōn** (§ **117**), *to seize* **fēng** (§ **239**) **fangen**

And similarly **hōn,** *to hang.*

Sub-division 2.

§ **515.** **bannan,** *to summon* **bēon(n)** **bannen**

And similarly **gangan,** pret. also **gīeng,** *to go*; **spannan,** *to join, clasp.*

§ **516.** **fealdan** (§ **64**), *to fold* **fēold** **fealden**

And similarly **feallan,** *to fall*; **healdan,** *to hold*; **stealdan,** *to possess*; **wealcan,** *to roll*; **wealdan,** *to rule*; **weallan,** *to boil*; **weaxan** (originally belonged to class VI), *to grow.*

§ **517.** **blą̄wan,** *to blow* **blēow** (§ **265**) **blāwen**

And similarly **cnāwan,** *to know*; **crāwan,** *to crow*; **māwan,** *to mow*; **sāwan,** *to sow*; **swāpan,** *to sweep*; **þrāwan,** *to turn, twist*; **wāwan,** *to blow.*

§ **518.** **bēatan,** *to beat* **bēot** **bēaten**

And similarly **āhnēapan,** *to pluck off*; **hēawan,** *to hew*; **hlēapan,** *to leap.*

§ **519.** **blōtan,** *to sacrifice* **blēot** **blōten**

And similarly **blōwan,** *to bloom, blossom*; **hrōpan,** *to shout*; **hwōpan,** *to threaten*; **flōwan,** *to flow*; **grōwan,** *to grow*; **hlōwan,** *to low, bellow*; **rōwan** (pret. pl. **rēon** beside **rēowon,** § **226**), *to row*; **spōwan,** *to succeed*; **wēpan** (Goth. **wōpjan**), *to weep.* The pret. of **flōcan,** *to clap, strike*; **swōgan,** *to sound*; **wrōtan,** *to root up,* do not occur.

## B. Weak Verbs.

§ **520.** The weak verbs, which for the most part are derivative or denominative, are divided in OE. into three classes according as the infinitive ends in **-an** (Goth. **-jan**), pret. **-ede, -de, -te** (Goth. **-ida, -ta**); **-ian** (Goth. **-ōn**) from older **-ōjan** (§ **273**), pret. **-ode** (Goth. **-ōda**); **-an** (Goth. **-an**),

pret. **-de** (Goth. **-áida**). The weak preterite is a special Germanic formation, and many points connected with its origin are still uncertain. Some scholars are inclined to regard it as a periphrastic formation which was originally confined to denominative verbs, and then at a later period became extended to primary verbs as well. The OE. endings **-de, -des(t), -de,** pl. **-don** (older **-dun**), would thus represent an old aorist formed from the root **dhē-**, *put, place* (Gr. τί-θη-μι), which stands in ablaut relation to OE. **dōn,** *to do.* The old preterite (perfect) of this verb has been preserved in the preterite plural of Gothic weak verbs, as **háusi-dēdum** (*we heard*), **-dēduþ, -dēdun.** But it is also probable that the dental in the OE. preterite stands in close relationship to the dental in the past participle, where the **-d** = prim. Germanic **-đás** = Gr. -τό-ς. Prim. Germanic **-đōn, -đǣs, -đǣ**(þ), pl. third pers. **-đun**(þ) from Indg. ***-dhnt** with vocalic **n,** regularly became **-de, -des(t), -de, -don** older **-dun** in OE. Three stems are to be distinguished in the conjugation of a weak verb: the stem of the present, preterite, and past participle, which mostly agrees with that of the preterite.

NOTE.—Many points concerning the inflexion of weak verbs in the oldest periods of the Germanic languages have never been satisfactorily explained. For a summary and discussion of the various explanations which have been suggested by scholars, the student should consult: Brugmann's Kurze vergleichende Grammatik der indogermanischen Sprachen; Streitberg's Urgermanische Grammatik; and Kluge's Vorgeschichte der altgermanischen Dialekte in Paul's Grundriss der germanischen Philologie, vol. I.

## CLASS I.

§ **521.** In OE. the verbs of this class are divided into two sub-divisions: (*a*) verbs which originally had a short stem-syllable; (*b*) polysyllabic verbs and those which

originally had a long stem-syllable. Nearly all the verbs belonging to this class are causative and denominative. On the personal endings, see §§ **273, 476–83.**

Sub-division (*a*).

§ **522.** Formation of the present stem: The present stem of verbs ending in a single consonant, except **r**, became long (except in the second and third pers. sing. pres. indicative, and second pers. sing. imperative) by the West Germanic law of the doubling of consonants (§ **254**). The **j** had already disappeared in these persons before the operation of the law, for which reason they had single consonants in OE. (§ **254,** Note).

§ **523.** Formation of the pret. and past participle: The **j**, which caused the doubling of the final consonants in the present stems, never existed in the preterite or past participle, so that these stems ended in single consonants. The pret. generally had the ending **-ede** from prim. Germanic **-iđōn,** but verbs whose present stems ended in **dd, tt** (= West Germanic **dj, tj**) had **-de, -te** on analogy with the verbs which originally had long stems (§ **528**). On many verbs whose present stems ended in **cc, ll** (= West Germanic **kj, lj**), see § **534.**

The past participle generally ended in **-ed** from older **-id,** prim. Germanic **-iđás,** as **genered, gefremed.** But in WS. and Ken. the verbs whose stems ended in **d, t** had vowel syncope and assimilation of consonants, as **geset(t),** masc. acc. sing. **gesetne,** dat. **gesettum,** fem. gen. dat. sing. **gesetre,** beside Anglian **geseted, gesetedne, gesettum, gesetedre; gehredd** beside Anglian **gehreded,** *rescued.* See § **300.**

§ **524.** The full conjugation of **nerian** (Goth. **nasjan**), *to save*; **fremman** (Goth. ***framjan**), *to perform*; **settan** (Goth. **satjan**), *to set,* will serve as models for this class.

*Present.*

Indicative.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | 1. | **nerie** | **fremme** | **sette** |
| | 2. | **neres(t)** | **fremes(t)** | **setst** |
| | 3. | **nereþ** | **fremeþ** | **set(t)** |
| Plur. | | **neriaþ** | **fremmaþ** | **settaþ** |

Subjunctive.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | **nerie** | **fremme** | **sette** |
| Plur. | **nerien** | **fremmen** | **setten** |

Imperative.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | 2. | **nere** | **freme** | **sete** |
| Plur. | 2. | **neriaþ** | **fremmaþ** | **settaþ** |

Infinitive.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **nerian** | **fremman** | **settan** |

Participle.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **neriende** | **fremmende** | **settende** |

*Preterite.*

Indicative.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | 1. | **nerede** | **fremede** | **sette** |
| | 2. | **neredes(t)** | **fremedes(t)** | **settes(t)** |
| | 3. | **nerede** | **fremede** | **sette** |
| Plur. | | **neredon** | **fremedon** | **setton** |

Subjunctive.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | **nerede** | **fremede** | **sette** |
| Plur. | **nereden** | **fremeden** | **setten** |

Participle.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **genered** | **gefremed** | **geseted, geset(t)** |

§ **525.** On forms like **nergan, nerigan, nerigean,** see § **271.** Like **nerian** are conjugated **āmerian,** *to purify*;

**andswerian,** *to answer*; **berian,** *to make bare*; **bescierian,** *to deprive*; **byrian,** *to pertain to, belong to*; **derian,** *to injure*; **erian,** *to plough*; **ferian,** *to carry*; **gewerian,** *to clothe*; **herian,** *to praise*; **onhyrian,** *to emulate*; **scierian,** *to allot*; **snyrian,** *to hasten*; **spyrian,** *to pursue*; **styrian,** *to stir*; **werian,** *to defend.*

In late WS. many of the verbs of this type went over into class II owing to the ending of the infinitive being the same in both classes.

§ **526.** Like **fremman** are conjugated **āswebban,** *to kill*; **clynnan,** *to sound*; **cnyssan,** *to knock*; **dynnan,** *to make a noise*; **gremman,** *to anger, provoke*; **hlynnan,** *to roar*; **hrissan,** *to shake*; **sceþþan** (also sv. § **510**), *to injure*; **sweþþan,** *to swathe*; **temman,** *to tame*; **trymman,** *to strengthen*; **þennan,** *to stretch*; **þicgan** (in poetry also strong pret. **þeah, þāh**), *to receive*; **wecgan,** *to agitate*; **wennan,** *to accustom*; **wreþþan,** *to support.*

In WS. and Ken. most of the verbs whose stems ended in **l, m, n, s, þ** were remodelled on analogy with verbs like **nerian** with single consonant, as **clynian, fremian, helian,** *to conceal,* **sylian,** *to sully,* **sweþian,** and then later often went over into class II. On the pret. and past participle of verbs ending in **þ**, see § **305.**

§ **527.** Like **settan** are conjugated **ātreddan,** *to search out*; **cnyttan,** *to bind, knit*; **hreddan,** *to rescue, save*; **hwettan,** *to whet, incite*; **lettan,** *to hinder*; **spryttan,** *to sprout*; and **lecgan,** *to lay.*

Sub-division (*b*).

§ **528.** The preterite generally ended in **-de** from older **-ide,** the **i** of which caused umlaut in the stem-syllable and then disappeared (§ **221**). The following points should be noted in regard to the consonants: (1) Germanic double consonants were simplified before **-de,** as **fyllan** (Goth. **fulljan**), *to fill,* pret. **fylde** (§ **259**), pp. **gefylled**; (2) **þ + d**

became **dd** in late WS., as **cȳþan,** *to make known,* pret. **cȳþde,** pp. **gecȳþed,** later **cȳdde** (§ **305**), pp. **gecȳd(d)** with **dd** from the inflected forms; (3) **-de** became **-te** after voiceless consonants (§ **300**), as **cyssan,** *to kiss,* pret. **cyste,** pp. **gecyssed**; **grētan,** *to greet,* pret. **grētte,** pp. **gegrēt(ed)**; (4) the **d** in **-de** disappeared after consonant + **d** or **t** (§ **229,** Note), as **sendan,** *to send,* pret. **sende,** pp. **gesend(ed)**; **fæstan,** *to make fast,* pret. **fæste,** pp. **gefæst(ed).** Verbs which would regularly have vocalic **l, n, r** in the pret. generally have **-ede,** especially in the combination long syllable + **l, n, r,** as **hyngran,** *to hunger,* **dīeglan,** *to hide,* pret. **hyngrede, dīeglede** (§ **221**); but in the combination short syllable + **l, n, r** they generally had **-de** in the oldest period of the language and then later **-ede,** as **eglan,** *to trouble,* pret. **eglde** beside later **eglede**; the verbs of this type often went over into class II (cp. § **222**).

§ **529.** The full conjugation of **dēman** (Goth. **dōmjan**), *to judge,* **drencan** (Goth. **dragkjan**), *to submerge,* **hyngran** (Goth. **huggrjan**), *to hunger,* and **gierwan** from ***gearwjan,** *to prepare,* will serve as models for this class.

*Present.*

Indicative.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. 1. | **dēme** | **drence** | **hyngre** | **gierwe** |
| 2. | **dēm(e)st** | **drenc(e)st** | **hyngrest** | **gierest** |
| 3. | **dēm(e)þ** | **drenc(e)þ** | **hyngreþ** | **giereþ** |
| Plur. | **dēmaþ** | **drencaþ** | **hyngraþ** | **gierwaþ** |

Subjunctive.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | **dēme** | **drence** | **hyngre** | **gierwe** |
| Plur. | **dēmen** | **drencen** | **hyngren** | **gierwen** |

Imperative.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. 2. | **dēm** | **drenc** | **hyngre** | **giere** |
| Plur. 2. | **dēmaþ** | **drencaþ** | **hyngraþ** | **gierwaþ** |

Infinitive.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| dēman | drencan | hyngran | gierwan |

Participle.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| dēmende | drencende | hyngrende | gierwende |

*Preterite.*

Indicative.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. 1. | dēmde | drencte | hyngrede | gierede |
| 2. | dēmdes(t) | drenctes(t) | hyngredes(t) | gieredes(t) |
| 3. | dēmde | drencte | hyngrede | gierede |
| Plur. | dēmdon | drencton | hyngredon | gieredon |

Subjunctive.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | dēmde | drencte | hyngrede | gierede |
| Plur. | dēmden | drencten | hyngreden | giereden |

Participle.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| gedēmed | gedrenced | gehyngred | gegier(w)ed |

§ **530.** Like **dēman** are conjugated a large number of verbs, as **ǣlan**, *to set on fire*; **ærnan**, *to gallop, cause to run*; **āflīegan**, *to put to flight*; **ālīefan**, *to allow*; **āwyrgan**, *to strangle, kill*; **bǣdan**, *to compel*; **bærnan**, *to burn up, cause to burn*; **benǣman**, *to deprive of*; **bīegan**, *to bend*; **brǣdan**, *to broaden*; **byrgan**, *to taste*; **byrgan**, *to bury*; **cēlan**, *to cool*; **cemban**, *to comb*; **cīegan** (§ **270**), *to call*; **cwielman**, *to kill*; **dǣlan**, *to share*; **dīedan**, *to kill*; **drǣfan**, *to drive out*; **drēfan**, *to stir up*; **drȳgan**, *to dry*; **ēaþmēdan**, *to humble*; **fēdan**, *to feed*; **fēgan**, *to join*; **fēran**, *to go, journey*; **flīeman**, *to put to flight*; **fylgan**, *to follow*; **fȳsan**, *to hasten*; **gefrēdan**, *to feel, perceive*; **gelīefan**, *to believe*; **geþīedan**, *to join together*; **gīeman**, *to heed*; **giernan**, *to desire, yearn for*; **glengan**, *to adorn*; **hǣlan**, *to heal*; **hǣman**, *to marry*; **hīenan**, *to humiliate, ill-use*; **hīeran**, *to hear*; **hlȳdan**, *to make a noise*; **hringan**, *to ring, sound*; **hȳdan**, *to hide*; **lǣdan**, *to lead*; **lǣfan**, *to leave*; **lǣnan**, *to*

*lend*; **læran**, *to teach*; **lengan**, *to require*; **līesan**, *to set free*; **mǣnan**, *to moan, complain*; **mǣran**, *to proclaim*; **mengan**, *to mix*; **nemnan** (pret. **nemde**, pp. **genem(n)ed**), *to name*; **nīedan**, *to compel*; **rǣran**, *to raise*; **rȳman**, *to make room*; **sǣgan**, *to lay low*; **sǣlan**, *to bind with a rope*; **scrȳdan**, *to clothe*; **sengan**, *to singe*; **sprǣdan**, *to spread*; **sprengan**, *to burst*; **stīeran**, *to steer*; **strīenan**, *to acquire*; **swēgan**, *to make a sound*; **tǣlan**, *to blame*; **tengan**, *to hasten*; **tȳnan**, *to enclose*; **wēdan**, *to rage*; **wēnan**, *to expect*; **wiernan**, *to refuse*; **wrēgan**, *to accuse*. The contracted verbs **hēan** (pret. **hēade**, pp. **hēad**), *to heighten, raise*; and similarly **rȳn**, *to roar*; **tȳn**, *to teach*; **þēon**, *to perform, do*; **þȳn** (also in form **þȳwan**), *to press*. **cȳþan** (pret. **cȳþde**, later **cȳdde**), *to make known*; and similarly **āhȳþan**, *to destroy, lay waste*; **cwīþan**, *to lament*; **lǣþan**, *to hate, abuse*; **nēþan**, *to venture on*; **oferswīþan**, *to overcome*; **sēþan**, *to testify*; **wrēþan**, *to be angry, get angry*. **fyllan** (pret. **fylde**), *to fill*; and similarly **āfierran**, *to remove*; **cennan**, *to bring forth*; **cierran**, *to turn*; **clyppan**, *to embrace*; **cyssan** (pret. **cyste**), *to kiss*; **fiellan**, *to fell*; **mierran**, *to mar*; **pyffan**, *to puff*; **spillan**, *to destroy*; **stillan**, *to still*; **wemman**, *to defile*. **ieldan** (pret. **ielde**), *to delay*, **sendan** (pret. **sende**), *to send*, **gyrdan** (pret. **gyrde**), *to gird*; and similarly **behyldan**, *to flay*; **gewieldan**, *to overpower*; **gyldan**, *to gild*; **onhieldan**, *to incline*; **scildan**, *to protect*; **spildan**, *to destroy*; **wieldan**, *to control, subdue*; **bendan**, *to bind*; **blendan**, *to blind*; **lendan**, *to land, arrive*; **ontendan**, *to kindle*; **pyndan**, *to shut up, confine*; **scendan**, *to put to shame*; **wendan**, *to turn*; **andwyrdan**, *to answer*; **āwierdan**, *to destroy*; **hierdan**, *to harden*; **onbyrdan**, *to inspire, incite*. **fæstan** (pret. **fæste**), *to make fast*; and similarly **ācræftan**, *to devise, plan*; **āfyrhtan**, *to frighten*; **āgyltan**, *to be guilty*; **āwēstan**, *to lay waste*; **efstan**, *to hasten*; **ēhtan**, *to pursue, persecute*; **fylstan**, *to help*; **gedæftan**, *to put in order*; **gehlæstan**, *to load*; **gehyrstan**,

*to equip*; **grimettan**, *to roar, rage* (for other examples of verbs in **-ettan**, see § **657**); **hæftan**, *to hold captive*; **hierstan**, *to roast*; **hiertan**, *to hearten, encourage*; **hlystan**, *to listen*; **hyhtan**, *to hope*; **læstan**, *to perform*; **līehtan**, *to give light*; **lystan**, *to please*; **mæstan**, *to feed with mast*; **myntan**, *to intend, think*; **restan**, *to rest*; **rihtan**, *to set right*; **scyrtan**, *to shorten*; **tyhtan**, *to incite, allure*; **þyrstan**, *to thirst.*

§ **531.** Like **drencan** are conjugated **ācwencan**, *to quench*; **ādwæscan**, *to quench*; **āstīepan**, *to bereave*; **bǣtan**, *to bridle*; **berīepan**, *to despoil*; **bētan**, *to atone for, amend*; **cēpan**, *to keep*; **cīepan**, *to buy*; **cyspan**, *to bind, fetter*; **drīepan**, *to let drop, moisten*; **gewlencan**, *to make proud*; **geswencan**, *to injure*; **grētan**, *to greet*; **hǣtan**, *to heat*; **hwierfan**, *to convert*; **hwītan**, *to whiten*; **hyspan**, *to mock*; **īecan** (see § **534**, Note **2**), *to increase*; **līexan**, *to shine*; **mētan**, *to meet*; **nǣtan**, *to afflict*; **oftyrfan**, *to stone*; **of þryscan**, *to beat down*; **rǣsan**, *to rush*; **rētan**, *to cheer*; **scencan**, *to pour out*; **scierpan**, *to sharpen*; **screncan**, *to cause to tumble*; **sencan**, *to cause to sink*; **spǣtan**, *to spit*; **swǣtan**, *to sweat*; **swencan**, *to vex, afflict*; **tǣsan**, *to pull, tear*; **tōstencan**, *to scatter*; **yppan**, *to open, manifest*; **wǣtan**, *to wet*; **wierpan**, *to recover*; **wȳscan**, *to wish.*

§ **532.** Like **hyngran** are conjugated **bīecnan**, *to make a sign*; **dīeglan**, *to conceal*; **forglendran**, *to devour*; **frēfran**, *to comfort*; **symblan**, *to feast*; **timbran**, *to build*; **wrixlan**, *to change, exchange.* **efnan** (pret. **efnde**, later **efnede**, § **528**), *to level, perform*; and similarly **bytlan**, *to build*; **eglan**, *to trouble, afflict*; **ræfnan**, *to perform*; **seglan**, *to sail*; **þrysman**, *to suffocate.*

§ **533.** **gierest**, **giereþ**, **gierede** from older ***gierwis**, ***gierwiþ**, ***gierwide** with regular loss of **w** (§ **266**). At a later period the verbs of this type mostly generalized the forms with or without **w**, and often went over into class II

The verbs with a long diphthong or vowel in the stem generally had **w** in all forms of the verb. Like **gierwan** are conjugated **hierwan,** *to despise, ill-treat*; **nierwan,** *to constrain*; **sierwan,** *to contrive, plot*; **smierwan,** *to anoint, smear.* **læwan** (pret. **læwde**), *to betray*; and similarly **forslæwan,** *to delay, be slow*; **getrīewan,** *to trust*; **hlēowan, hlīewan,** *to shelter, warm*; **īewan,** *to show, disclose.*

**sīowan, sēowan** (Goth. **siujan,** OHG. **siuwen**) from older ***siuwjan** (cp. § **138**), *to sew*, pret. **siowede, seowede** from older ***siwide**; from the pret. was formed a new inf. **si(o)wian** after the analogy of class II, with preterite **siowode, seowode. spīowan, spēswan** from ***spiuwjan** older ***spiwwjan** (§ **254**), *to spit*, pret. **spiowede, speowede** from ***spiwide,** beside **spīode, spēode,** formed direct from the present; from the pret. **spiowede** was formed a new inf. **spi(o)wian** after the analogy of class II. **streowan** (Goth. **straujan**), *to strew*, pret. **streowede** beside **strewede** (Goth. **strawida**), § **77,** from which a new inf. **streowian, strewian** was formed after the analogy of class II, pret. **streowode.**

§ **534.** A certain number of verbs belonging to class I formed their preterite and past participle already in prim. Germanic without the medial vowel **-i-**, as **bycgan** (Goth. **bugjan**), *to buy*, pret. **bohte** (Goth. **baúhta**), pp. **geboht** (Goth. **baúhts**); **þencan** (Goth. **þagkjan**), *to think*, pret. **þōhte** (Goth. **þāhta,** § **40**), pp. **geþōht** (Goth. **þāhts**), whence the absence of **i**-umlaut in the pret. and past participle of verbs of this type. In addition to a few verbs which had long stems originally, they embrace verbs whose present stems end in **cc, ll** from West Germanic **kj** and **lj** (§ **254**). On the interchange between **c** and **h,** see § **240.** At a later period the preterite and pp. of verbs with **-ecc-** in the present were re-formed with **e** from the present, as **cweccan, cwehte, gecweht;** and similarly **rǣcan, tǣcan,** prim. Germanic ***raikjan,** ***taikjan,** gener-

ally had pret. **rǣhte, tǣhte** with **ǣ** from the present, beside the regular forms **rāhte, tāhte.** The verbs with **ll** in the present often formed the pret. and pp. on analogy with the verbs of sub-division (*a*) especially in late OE., as **dwelede, -ode,** beside older **dwealde.** Beside **sellan** there also occurs **siellan** (later **syllan**) from ***sealljan** with **ea** borrowed from the pret. and pp. in prehistoric OE. **bringan,** *to bring,* is the strong form (cp. § **498**), the regular weak form **brengan** is rare in OE.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **bycgan,** *to buy* | **bohte** | **geboht** |
| **cweccan,** *to shake* | **cweahte** | **gecweaht** |
| **dreccan,** *to afflict* | **dreahte** | **gedreaht** |
| **leccan,** *to moisten* | **leahte** | **geleaht** |
| **reccan,** *to narrate* | **reahte** | **gereaht** |
| **streccan,** *to stretch* | **streahte** | **gestreaht** |
| **þeccan,** *to cover* | **þeahte** | **geþeaht** |
| **weccan,** *to awake* | **weahte** | **geweaht** |
| **cwellan,** *to kill* | **cwealde** | **gecweald** |
| **dwellan,** *to hinder* | **dwealde** | **gedweald** |
| **sellan,** *to sell* | **sealde** | **geseald** |
| **stellan,** *to place* | **stealde** | **gesteald** |
| **tellan,** *to count* | **tealde** | **geteald** |
| **rǣcan,** *to reach* | **rǣhte, rāhte** | **gerǣht** |
| **tǣcan,** *to teach* | **tǣhte, tāhte** | **getǣht, getāht** |
| **sēcan,** *to seek* | **sōhte** | **gesōht** |
| **bringan,** *to bring* | **brōhte** | **gebrōht** |
| **þencan,** *to think* | **þōhte** | **geþōht** |
| **þyncan,** *to seem* | **þūhte** | **geþūht** |
| **wyrcan,** *to work* | **worhte** | **geworht** |

NOTE.—1. The presents **reccan** for ***rēcan** (pret. **rōhte**), *to care for, reck*; and **læccan** for ***lǣcan** (pret **lǣhte**, pp. **gelǣht**), *to seize,* are difficult to account for.

2. Especially in late OE. verbs with medial **c, cc** often formed their pret. and pp. in **-hte, -ht** after the analogy of the above type of verbs, but with the retention of **i**-umlaut, as **bepǣcan,** *to*

*deceive,* **bepǣhte, bepǣht,** beside older **bepǣcte, bepǣct**; and similarly **gewǣcan,** *to weaken*; **īecan,** *to increase*; **nēalǣcan,** *to approach* (for further examples of verbs with **-lǣcan,** see § 658); **ōleccan,** *to flatter*; **sȳcan,** *to suckle*; **þryccan,** *to press, crush*; **wleccan,** *to warm.*

## Class II.

§ **535.** This class of verbs is denominative and originally belonged partly to the athematic and partly to the thematic conjugation (§ **472**). The first pers. singular of the former ended in **-āmi** and of the latter in **-ājō.** The **ā** became **ō** in the prim. Germanic period (§ **23**). A large number of the verbs which originally belonged to class III went over into this class in prehistoric OE. On the verbs of class I which went over into this class, see §§ **525–6, 533.**

The full conjugation of **sealfian,** *to anoint,* will serve as a model for the verbs of this class.

*Present.*

| | Indic. | Subj. | Imper. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. 1. | **sealfie** | **sealfie** | |
| 2. | **sealfas(t)** | ,, | **sealfa** |
| 3. | **sealfaþ** | ,, | |
| Plur. | **sealfiaþ** | **sealfien** | **sealfiaþ** |

Infinitive.
**sealfian**

Participle.
**sealfiende**

*Preterite.*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Sing. 1. | **sealfode** | **sealfode** |
| 2. | **sealfodes(t)** | ,, |
| 3. | **sealfode** | ,, |
| Plur. | **sealfodon** | **sealfoden** |

Participle.
**gesealfod**

The corresponding prim. Germanic forms of the pres. indicative were: *salþōjō, *salþōsi (Goth. salbōs), *salþōþi (Goth. salbōþ), pl. *salþōjanþi. In OE. -ōj- regularly became -i- (§ 273) which not being original did not cause i-umlaut in the stem-syllable. The -i- was often written -ig-, also -ige- before guttural vowels, as **sealfige, sealfigan, sealfigean,** beside **sealfie, sealfian,** see § 273. On the ending -e in the first pers. sing. of the present, see § 476. The ending -a in the imperative second pers. sing. was from **sealfas(t)**; a form corresponding to Goth. **salbō** would have become in OE. ***sealf** from older ***sealþu** (§ 215). Inf. **sealfian** is from prim. Germanic ***salþō-janan.**

The corresponding prim. Germanic forms of the pret. indicative were ***salþōđōn** (Goth. **salbōda**), ***salþōđǣs** (Goth. **salbōdēs**), ***salþōđǣ(þ)** (Goth. **salbōda**), pl. ***salþō-đun(þ).** The medial -ō- was regularly shortened to -u- in prehistoric OE. (§ 218) and then later became -o-, -a-, the former of which is usual in WS. and the latter in Anglian and Ken. On -e- beside -o-, -a-, see § 222. And similarly in the past participle WS. -od, Anglian and Ken. -ad, prim. Germanic -ōđaz.

§ 536. Like **sealfian** are conjugated a large number of verbs, as **ācealdian,** *to become cold*; **ārian,** *to honour*; **āscian,** *to ask*; **āswefecian,** *to eradicate*; **bedecian,** *to beg*; **behōfian,** *to have need of*; **bodian,** *to announce*; **cēapian,** *to buy*; **ceorian,** *to complain*; **costian,** *to try, prove*; **cunnian,** *to try, test*; **dysigian,** *to be foolish*; **dwolian,** *to err*; **eahtian,** *to esteem, consider*; **eardian,** *to dwell, inhabit*; **earnian,** *to earn*; **endian,** *to end*; **fæg(e)nian,** *to rejoice*; **fæstnian,** *to fasten*; **fandian,** *to try, search out*; **folgian,** *to follow*; **fullian,** *to fulfil*; **fundian,** *to strive after*; **gearcian,** *to prepare*; **gearwian** (§ 533), *to prepare*; **gedafenian,** *to beseem*; **gemīdlian,** *to bridle, restrain*; **gemyndgian,** *to remember*; **geōmrian,** *to be sad, lament*; **gestrangian,** *to*

*make strong*; **grāpian**, *to grope, feel*; **hafenian**, *to hold*; **hālgian**, *to hallow*; **hangian**, *to hang*; **hatian**, *to hate*; **hef(i)gian**, *to make heavy*; **hergian** (cp. § **525**), *to harry*; **hīgian**, *to hasten*; **hnappian**, *to doze*; **hopian**, *to hope*; **hwearfian**, *to wander*; **ieldcian**, *to delay*; **lācnian**, *to heal*; **langian**, *to long for*; **laþian**, *to invite*; **lēanian**, *to reward*; **lēasian**, *to tell lies*; **līcian**, *to please*; **lōcian**, *to look*; **lofian**, *to praise*; **losian**, *to lose*; **lufian**, *to love*; **macian**, *to make*; **manian**, *to exhort*; **meldian**, *to announce*; **met(e)gian**, *to measure*; **offrian**, *to offer*; **op(e)nian**, *to open*; **rēafian**, *to plunder*; **samnian**, *to collect, gather*; **sārgian**, *to cause pain*; **sārian**, *to grieve, be sad*; **scamian**, *to be ashamed*; **scēawian**, *to look*; **scyld(i)gian**, *to sin*; **sīþian**, *to travel*; **sorgian**, *to sorrow, grieve*; **sparian**, *to spare*; **syngian**, *to sin*; **tiohhian**, **teohhian**, *to think, consider*; **þaccian**, *to stroke*; **þancian**, *to thank*; **þolian**, *to suffer*; **þrōwian**, *to suffer*; **wacian**, *to be awake*; **wandrian**, *to wander*; **war(e)nian**, *to beware, take heed*; **warian**, *to beware*; **wealwian**, *to roll, wallow*; **welegian**, *to enrich*; **weorþian**, *to honour*; **wērgian**, *to grow weary*; **wilnian**, *to desire*; **wincian**, *to wink*; **wīsian**, *to guide*; **wītgian**, *to prophesy*; **wītnian**, *to punish, torment*; **wuldrian**, *to glorify*; **wundian**, *to wound*; **wundrian**, *to wonder*; **wunian**, *to dwell*. **bletsian**, *to bless*; **blīþsian**, **blissian**, *to rejoice*; **clǣnsian**, *to cleanse*; **efesian**, *to shear*; **eg(e)sian**, *to frighten, terrify*; **gītsian**, *to covet*; **grimsian**, *to rage*; **hrēowsian**, *to repent of, rue*; **iersian**, *to be angry*; **mǣrsian**, *to make famous*; **miltsian**, *to have mercy*; **rīcsian**, **rīxian**, *to rule, govern*; **unrōtsian**, *to be sad*; **untrēowsian**, *to defraud, deceive*, see § **659**.

On the second and third pers. sing. pres. indic., imperative sing., and pret. indicative of verbs like **bifian**, *to tremble*; **clifian**, *to adhere, cleave*; **clipian**, *to call*; **ginian**, *to yawn, gape*; **hlinian**, *to lean, recline*; **stician**, *to prick, stab*; **tilian**, *to strive after, labour*, see §§ **101–2**.

§ **537**. **twēogan**, Anglian **twīogan**, from *twiχōjan

(§§ **98, 139**), *to doubt*; pres. indic. **twēoge, twēost, twēoþ**; pres. part. **twēonde** (poetical) beside **twēogende**; pret. indic. **twēode,** Anglian **twīode,** from ***twiχōđōn**; pp. **twēod.** And similarly in WS. the following verbs which originally belonged to class III: **fēog(e)an,** *to hate*; **frēog(e)an,** *to love, make free*; **smēag(e)an,** *to ponder, consider*; **þrēag(e)an,** *to reprove, rebuke.*

## Class III.

§ **538.** Most of the verbs belonging to this class were originally primary verbs like Lat. **habē·re,** OHG. **habē·n,** *to have,* and probably embraced two types of verbs: (1) those which had **·ēj·,** and (2) those which simply had **·j·** in the present. In OE. as in the other Germanic languages the two types became mixed, which gave rise to many new formations. **The ·ēj·** like **·ōj·** (§ **273**) in class II regularly became **·i·** in OE., which is the reason why nearly all the verbs of class III went over into class II in the prehistoric period of the language, cp. **hatian,** Goth. **hatan,** OHG. **hazzēn,** prim. Germanic ***χatējanan,** *to hate.* The preterite and past participle were formed without a medial vowel. The chief verbs are: **habban,** *to have*; **libban,** *to live*; **secgan,** *to say*; and **hycgan,** *to think.*

### *Present.*

Indicative.

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | 1. | **hæbbe** | **libbe** | **secge** | **hycge** |
| | 2. | **hafas(t)** / **hæfst** | **liofas(t)** | **sagas(t)** / **sægst** | **hogas(t)** / **hyg(e)st** |
| | 3. | **hafaþ** / **hæfþ** | **liofaþ** | **sagaþ** / **sægþ** | **hogaþ** / **hyg(e)þ** |
| Plur. | | **habbaþ** | **libbaþ** | **secg(e)aþ** | **hycg(e)aþ** |

Subjunctive.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | **hæbbe** | **libbe** | **secge** | **hycge** |
| Plur. | **hæbben** | **libben** | **secgen** | **hycgen** |

Imperative.

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | 2. | **hafa** | **liofa** | **saga, sæge** | **hoga, hyge** |
| Plur. | 2. | **habbaþ** | **libbaþ** | **secg(e)aþ** | **hycg(e)aþ** |

Infinitive.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **habban** | **libban** | **secg(e)an** | **hycg(e)an** |

Participle.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **hæbbende** | **libbende** | **secgende** | **hycgende** |

*Preterite.*

Indicative.

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | 1. | **hæfde** | **lifde** | **sægde** | **hogde** |
| | 2. | **hæfdes(t)** | **lifdes(t)** | **sægdes(t)** | **hogdes(t)** |
| | 3. | **hæfde** | **lifde** | **sægde** | **hogde** |
| Plur. | | **hæfdon** | **lifdon** | **sægdon** | **hogdon** |

Subjunctive.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | **hæfde** | **lifde** | **sægde** | **hogde** |
| Plur. | **hæfden** | **lifden** | **sægden** | **hogden** |

Participle.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **gehæfd** | **gelifd** | **gesægd** | **gehogod** |

The endings **-as(t)**, **-aþ** of the second and third pers. sing. pres indicative, and **-a** of the imperative sing., were from verbs of class II; the endings corresponding to Goth. **-áis, -áiþ, -ái** would have become **-es(t), -eþ, -e** in OE. The regular form of **hæbbe** would be ***hebbe** (OS. **hebbiu**) from West Germanic ***χabbjō,** but the **a** of the second and third pers. sing. was extended to the first and then **a** became **æ** by **i**-umlaut, cp. § **55,** Note 2. On the **æ** beside **a** in the second and third pers. singular, see §§ **54, 57. hafas(t), hafaþ** are rare in pure WS., the usual forms are **hæfst, hæfþ**; and similarly with **sægst, sægþ; hyg(e)st, hyg(e)þ. habbaþ, habban** (West Germanic ***χabbjanþi, *χabbja-**

**nan**, OS. **hebbiad, hebbian**) had the **a** in the stem-syllable from **hafas(t), hafaþ**. On forms like **næbbe** from **ne hæbbe**, see § **325**, Note.

**libbe** (OS. **libbiu**), **libban** (OS. **libbian**), from West Germanic ***libbjō, *libbjanan.** Beside **libban** there was also **lifian**, common in Anglian and Ken., which was inflected like **sealfian** (§ **535**) in the present. On the **io** in **liofas(t)** and **liofaþ**, see § **102**.

**secge** (OS. **seggiu**), **secg(e)an** (OS. **seggian**), from W es Germanic ***saggjō, *saggjanan.** In the present the **e** as in **secge, secg(e)an** was often extended to forms which regularly had **æ**, and vice versa. In late WS. the **e** was extended to all forms of the present. On forms like pret. **sǣde** beside **sægde**, see § **54**, Note 2.

On the **y** in **hycg(e)an** beside the **o** in **hogde**, see § **43**. In the pret. this verb was also inflected like class II, **hogode**, &c.; cp. also the past participle **gehogod** for ***gehogd.**

NOTE.—Traces of the old inflexion of verbs which originally belonged to class III are seen in such forms as **bȳa** (Nth.), *to dwell*, **fylg(e)an**, *to follow*, **onscynian** (Anglian), *to shun*, **wæccende**, *being awake*, beside **būan, folgian, onscunian, waciende**; **hettend**, *enemy*, beside **hatian**, *to hate*; pret. **plægde, trūde**, beside **plagode**, *he played*, **trūwian**, *to trust.*

## C. MINOR GROUPS.

### A. PRETERITE-PRESENTS.

§ **539**. These verbs were originally unreduplicated perfects, which acquired a present meaning like Gr. **οἶδα**, Latin **nōvī**, *I know.* In prim. Germanic a new weak preterite, an infinitive, a pres. participle, and in some verbs a strong past participle, were formed. They are inflected in the present like the preterite of strong verbs, except that the second pers. singular has the same stem-